Hack-Nation in collaboration with MIT CNC, MIT Club of Germany, MIT Sloan AI Club

Hack-Nation's

4th Global AI Hackathon & Venture Incubation Program

in collaboration with MIT Sloan AI Club & MIT Club of Northern California

Empowering the next generation of top AI builders & entrepreneurs.

Sponsored by

Google, OpenAI, SAP, Eleven Labs, كامبس دبي للذكاء الاصطناعي DUBAI AI CAMPUS, MIT MANAGEMENT OFFICE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING, Deutsche Bank, AkashX, Lovable, National Consulting Partners, KELLY

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Next event: Feb

Our hackathons run on for 24h on weekends

Time (ET)

Saturday, Feb 7

Hackathon kick-off	*10:00 AM-10:45 AM*
Speaker sessions	*10:45 AM-11:45 AM*
15-mins break	*11:45 AM-12:00 PM*
Reveal of challenges	*12:00 PM – 12:15 PM*
Hacking begins	*12:15 PM*
Deadline for challenge selection and API credit application	*1:15 PM*

Sunday, Feb 8

Submission deadline	*9:00 AM*
Jury to select Top 16 Teams	*By 2:00 PM*
Finalist Pitches & Jury Voting	*2:30 PM-3:30 PM*
Awards Ceremony	*3:45 PM*

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We believe hackathons are the best way…

…to **kick-start innovation** in your company with prototypes

…to gain **access to world-class AI talent** from around the world

…to **build and incubate** new AI-first ventures

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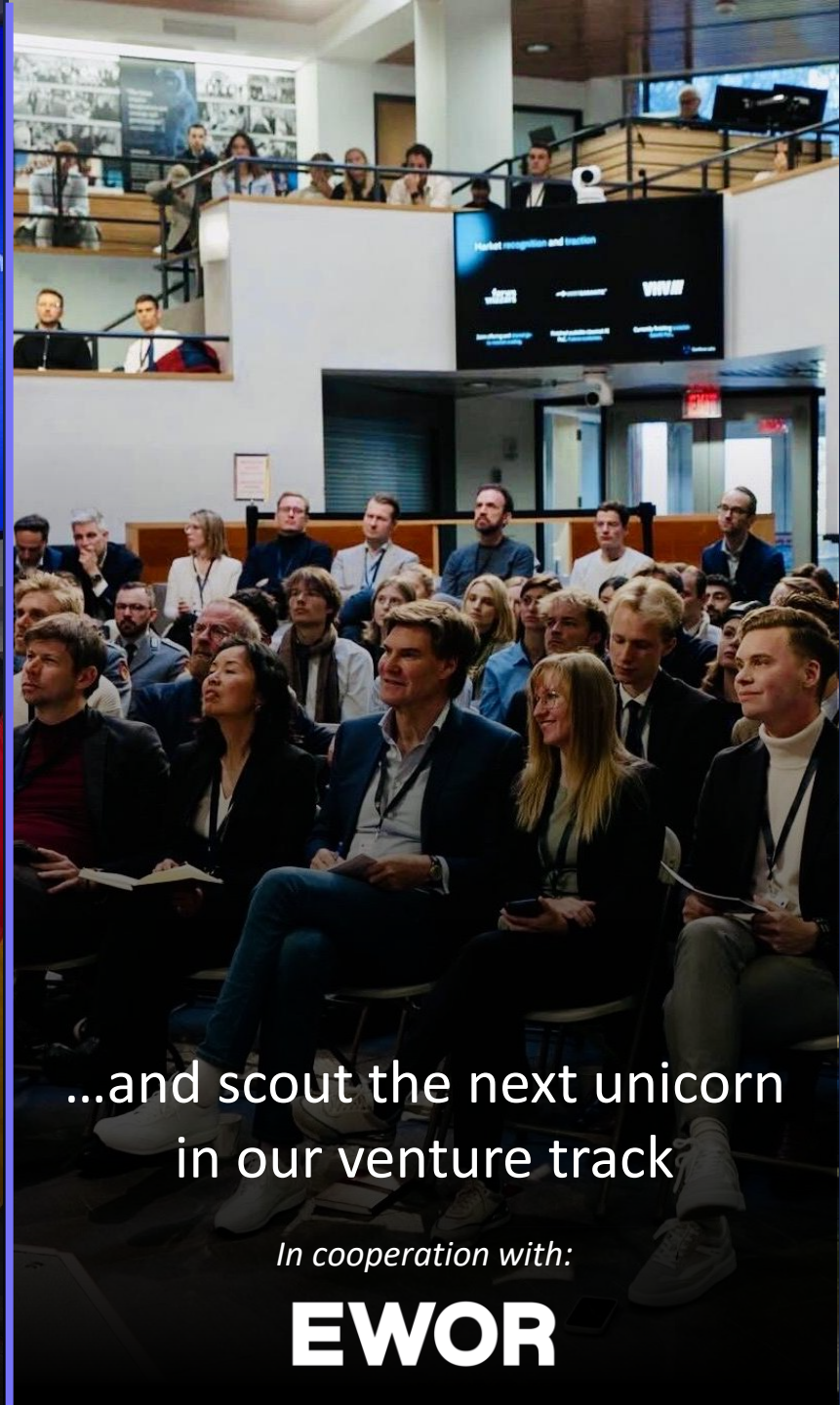
Hack-Nation

At Hack-Nation, we host large-scale hackathons…

…to solve challenges for partners in our corporate track

Google | OpenAI | SAP | Deutsche Bank | AkashX | Eleven Labs | National Consulting Partners | KELLY | scale | Lovable



…and scout the next unicorn in our venture track

In cooperation with:

EWOR

What makes Hack-Nation's Global AI Hackathon unique?

We are not looking for the best idea. We are looking for the best solution.

*Organizers provide 12 **pre-defined AI moonshot challenges** which participants tackle within 24 h.*

Jury members & mentors are mainly MIT & Harvard alums.

Participants have unique opportunities.

Hack with the best AI builders across MIT, Harvard, Standford & beyond.

$25k in OpenAI API credits as prizes + cash.

The hackathon is the gateway for an exclusive venture track to launch AI startups.

*And our **scale is crazy**! 1000+ AI builders, 300+ universities, 65+ countries!*

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Social Impact | Tackle meaningful challenges across 8 different impact dimensions

1

AI for Health

Drug discovery, protein design or healthcare adjacent

2

AI for Science

Accelerating physics, chemistry & materials research

3

Open-source AI

Core models enabling discovery across domains

4

Energy & water

Optimizing energy systems & water access

5

Climate

Climate modeling, mitigation & adaptation solutions

6

Education & jobs

Personalized learning & workforce transformation

7

Robotics

Intelligent automation for physical systems / embodied AI

8

Agriculture

Precision farming & sustainable food systems

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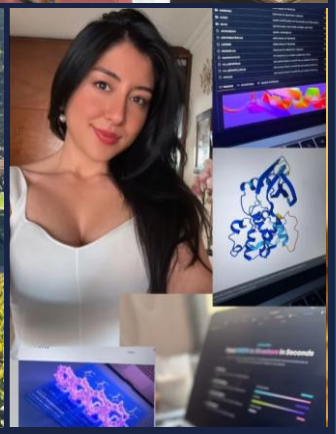
In 24h our 1,300+ AI talents from world-class institutions work on AI solutions…

1,300+ participants per hackathon

65+ countries

300+ universities

RWTH AACHEN UNIVERSITY · Harvard University · MIT · University of Oxford · TUM · KIT · HPI Hasso Plattner Institut · University of Cambridge · University of Toronto · ETH zürich · Stanford · LMU



Who are the AI rockstars that participate? Please meet previous winners

Natalie Chan
Engineering @ Imperial | Self-taught Full Stack x AI Developer | 6x Hackathon Winner

Area of expertise: Master in winning hackathons, 3DGS, bioengineering

"I love building and taught myself fullstack development in and between hackathons, studying computer science in my spare time. I'm so proud to be part of the vibrant London tech and founder communities"

Demo video: Watch here

Who are the AI rockstars that participate? Please meet previous winners

Ronan McCooey
MSc Business Analytics @MIT

Area of expertise: Video analytics, video generation, ML & economics

“There is nothing better than to build something cool with your friends”

Watch interview: Click here

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Our hackathons are hybrid: online + in-person
We have successfully orchestrated eight local hubs around the world

Boston, MA, USA
MIT Sloan AI Club

MIT Sloan AI Club

Stanford, USA
Local hackers

Bhubaneswar, India
KIIT DU

KIIT

San Francisco, USA
Qlay

Qlay | MIT MITCNC

Dubai, UAE
Dubai AI Campus

كامبس دبي للذكاء الاصطناعي
DUBAI AI CAMPUS

Oxford, UK
Local hackers

London, UK
Hack-Nation

Hack-Nation

Munich, Germany
Purple Bird Tech.

Purple Bird Technology

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Our 80+ judges from MIT, Harvard, big tech and others, judge our 200+ submissions per hackathon …

Judges

Fridolin Haugg Harvard	Konstantina Yaneva Harvard	Pranav Parekh Adobe	Ishaan Chandrateya MIT	Sophia Luo Greylock	Dr. Leon Pietschmann Realworld One	Nik Kale Cisco	Dhruv Mehrotra AI Solutions Group	Thomas Wolf Indoor Astronaut	Andrea Zanon Jetblue
Gabriela Torres Vives Sundai & Aethos	Christina Ye Adobe	Marton Sziraczki Ex-Waymo	Hyeyeon Hwang Tinos Therapeutics	Jean-Claude Ton OpenAI	Rahul Rai Meta	Michelle Winters Amazon	Chinmay Patel YC S25	Elliot Queisser Oxford	Jennifer Liu Rise Like a Phoenix
Nikolay Vyahhi Hyperskill	Marius Wiggert Evolutionaryscale	Mihcael Boensel MIT Lincoln Lab	Sathwik Karnik Stanford	Martin Buttenschoen Oxford	Paras Patel Rakuten	Min-Ha Hwang Microsoft	Robert Rogers McKinsey	Jakub Lala Imperial College London	Alex Qi Nvidia
Matt Casavant Verizon	Regina Ceballos Microsoft	Felix Krones McKinsey	Mario Brachlein Meta	Chloe Fang MIT	Samir Meghani Greenland Invest.	Luna Maroun Adobe	Yash Dixit McKinsey	Natalia Sikora Oxford	Louisamay Hanrahan Callm Intelligence
Kris Inapurapu Akashx	Kartik Kulkarni Akashx	Darshan Nagaraj Akashx	Arvind Saraf Microsoft	Hakan Sonmez IBM	Robert Windesheim Founders Fund	Max Niroomand Lyceum	Chee-we Ng Oakseed Ventures	Bilge Aksu Mobi AI	Onno Van der Horst Databricks
Salvador Alvarez Synopsys	Jiaxin Pei Stanford	Yon Chung Florence AI Ventures	Emily Wesel Verily	Florian Dahlhausen Sierra	Parikshit Sharma Meta	Max L'Etoile Aluminio	Allen Bolourchi Meta	Irina Starikova Nokia	…

…and connect in-person or virtually

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What happens after the hackathons?

Selected winners join our **accelerator** program

We partnered with the Y Combinator of Europe. EWOR - Europe's **best accelerator**

Hack-Nation

X

EWOR

Through our incubation program, we want to…

Spot **AI talent** and connect them with **mentors** who have walked the path before

Build and iterate at **lightning speed**, transforming concepts into **market-ready products**

Be **the growth partner for our 'hackers"**, supporting their journey from hackathon spark to industry-changing success

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Ideas born during Hack-Nation's hackathons received Y Combinator backing & founders have raised

David de Gruijl
Founder @ Anto (YC F25)

"I did the Hack-Nation hackathon this summer … applied with the same idea to Y Combinator and got in! Just finished the batch and raised a seed :) - can't thank you guys enough."

LinkedIn

Our venture track combines mentoring with funding opportunities

- **Structured mentorship program**
- **Demo days to iterate product & pitch**
- **Investor day to secure a pre-seed ticket**

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Our venture track successfully identifies & mentors over achievers: Teams boosted by our program have outperformed YC-backed start-ups at recent Harvard pitch competitions

Congratulations Dr. Janet Brinz – AI researcher & dentist launching Finmedio and winning a $10K grant at Harvard

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Appendix

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Our hackathons resulted in 600+ trained AI models and prototypes – select winners below

1

1st Prize Hackathon 1

Team SynthShape

Stanford University

Challenge:
Generative 3D jewelry design: from prompt or image to printable shape

Link to video

2

2nd Prize Hackathon 1

Team ThermoTrace

MIT

Challenge:
Anomaly detection for thermal drone footage and visual Inspection

Link to video

3

3rd Prize Hackathon 1

Team AI Scam Shield

Code University Berlin

Challenge:
Multilingual scam detection agent for WhatsApp and websites

Link to video

4

Creativity winner Hackathon 2

Team AG3334

ENSICAEN Paris

Challenge:
AI for financial document analysis & investment strategy building

Link to video

5

2nd prize VC Big Bets

Team Gould Standard

Dana Faber & Broad Institute & Harvard

Challenge:
AI system that to predict protein structure using smaller datasets

Link to video

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Sample challenge 1: AI Sports Coach – Conversational performance insights by ElevenLabs

Build an AI sports coach that delivers conversational insights on performance, tactics, and training using real-time data and voice interaction.

The goal is to make performance analytics more engaging and accessible for athletes and coaches.

Sponsored by

ElevenLabs

Detailed info on challenge:
Link

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Sample challenge 2 : AkashX.ai: FinDocGPT – AI for financial document analysis & investment strategy

Create an AI that can parse, analyze, and summarize complex financial documents to inform smarter investment strategies.

Think of it as your always-on financial analyst who never misses a detail.

Sponsored by

AkashX

Detailed infos on challenge:
Link

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Sample challenge 3 : VC Big Bet
From Sketch to Sky – AI for 3D design generation for airplanes

VC Track

Create an AI-powered 3D aircraft-design generator that converts natural-language prompts ("Design a Boeing 737") into production-ready CAD models.

Solution developed within 24 h: Watch here

1st Place 3rd Global AI Hackathon
Natalie Chan, Imperial College London

Who are the AI rockstars that participate? Please meet previous winners

Paul Goldschmidt
AI Researcher at Stanford

Area of expertise: AI for 3D generation, AI for biodesign & digital health.

Loves running & is training for a marathon.

Who are the AI rockstars that participate? Please meet previous winners

Daniel Rapoport
MSc Business Analytics @MIT

Area of expertise: Video analytics, video generation, ML for FinTec applications

In his free time he participates in hackathons & loves traveling.

Watch interview: Click here